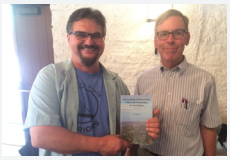
MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume VIII | Issue IV | Summer 2018



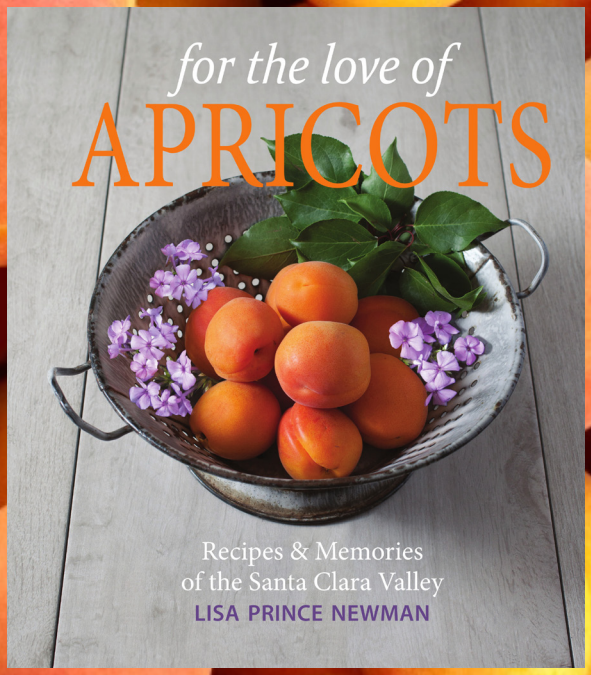
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MVHA Summer Event

ABOUT THE EVENT

As summer draws to a close, the MVHA invites you to join us as we celebrate all-things-apricot at our annual August get-together. We are very excited to be joined by special guest speaker Lisa Prince Newman, author of the new book, "For the Love of Apricots: Recipes and Memories of the Santa Clara Valley." This unique book blends heritage recipes and modern tastes in a cookbook that showcases the versatility of California's beloved and world-renowned fruit. Essays woven throughout the book provide historical perspective on the Valley of Heart's Delight, as well as the author's memories of growing up on an orchard property as the fruitful landscape was being plowed under to form the Silicon Valley; perhaps one of history's most dramatic transformations to occur within one generation.

ABOUT OUR GUEST SPEAKER



Lisa Prince Newman was born in Seattle, Washington, and moved to California with her family in the 1960s where they settled first in San Jose and then Saratoga. The Prince family lived on an orchard property with views of the Santa Clara Valley. It was there Lisa gained a deep appreciation for the land, the seasons, and the region's agricultural heritage. At Stanford University, Lisa studied Land Resources Planning and later earned a Masters degree in City and Regional Planning at UC Berkeley. Married and the mother of four children, Lisa lives in Marin County where she works in city planning. Lisa's inspirations also include her mother's creativity in the kitchen and devotion to gardening, augmented by many courses from Bay Area cooking schools. Cooking, baking, and entertaining are a centerpiece of her everyday life.

SUNDAY, AUGUST 19, 2018 ● 1:00-3:00 P.M. ● HISTORIC ADOBE BUILDING, 157 MOFFETT BLVD., MTN. VIEW CA ● FREE & OPEN TO ALL

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Hop on Board!

Help chart the future of your historical association! Board Elections take place in November 2018. If you are interested in joining our Board, please contact us today:

MVHA Board of Directors
Email: info@mountainviewhistorical.org
Voicemail: (650) 903-6890

News & Notes

President's Message



By Candace Bowers
MVHA President

Happy summer!

This year, we are trying something new for our summer gathering: we are taking a hiatus from the hot-yet-rewarding work of BBQ'ing, and are concentrating on all things apricot! We are thrilled to have apricot aficionado Lisa Prince Newman as our special guest. You'll be able to sample treats from her popular cookbook, while learning more about our agricultural heritage. If you're a fan of our beloved local stone fruit, you won't want to miss this event.

I recently spent some time in the orchard myself—last month, I gathered with like-minded fruit fans to pick peaches and nectarines in the San Joaquin Valley. (We do this as part of an "adopt-a-tree" program, where we buy into a share of the orchard and get to harvest our assigned trees.) We saw up-close how unpredictable the harvest can be. A stretch of triple-digit temperatures had actually slowed down the ripening process—somewhat confusingly—to us city folks. And all the trees were different— one tree might be full of ripe fruit, while its neighbor was still holding onto fruit that was tinged with green. Our nectarine tree, which gave us an abundance of ripe fruit three years ago, was less generous this year. That's just how nature works, and not everyone realizes it. What do I do with all the fruit I pick? Hint: you'll get a taste if you come to our summer event.

See you at the Adobe—

Candace



Financial Report

By Emily Ramos
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 4/24/2018:
$24,557.05
Income:
$33.11
Expenses:
$3,373.09
Checking Account Balance as of 7/15/2018:
$27,897.03

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 1/19/2018:
$60,028.90
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 7/15/2018:
$60,108.75

Why No BBQ?

By Nick Perry
MVHA Vice President

Hello everyone! Many of you are probably wondering why our summer event does not feature our traditional BBQ. Let me offer a quick explanation.

Last year we decided to cater the BBQ for the first time and hired the Gold Rush Eatery food truck to serve their version of the classic Linda's Parisian Burger. In previous years MVHA volunteers grilled the burgers ourselves on-site, but with greater attendance and a shortage of volunteers available to grill the burgers, we decided to switch to catering.

Unfortunately, this year the Gold Rush Eatery was not available on any Sundays in August, which left us in a bit of a pickle. To further complicate matters, we discovered in July that the Adobe Building was booked on our normal BBQ date (the first Sunday of August). The uncertainty over both the date and catering forced us to delay release of this newsletter and ate into the time we would normally use to promote the BBQ and sell tickets.

So we hope those of you pining for an MVHA BBQ Parisian Burger don't mind a one-year break too much. We hope you'll still join us for what is sure to be a fun, free, and tasty Apricot-themed summer meeting on August 19!

Inaugural MV Harvest History Festival this September

By Marina Marinovich
MVHA Director-at-Large

Before there was tech, there were orchards. Silicon Valley was known as The Valley of Heart's Delight, and Mountain View nestled serenely at its center.

Come to the Harvest History Festival and celebrate our valley's rich and fertile past. Mountain view's Heritage Park at 771 North Rengstorff Avenue will be home to this family-friendly event on Saturday September 22, from 9:00 a.m. to noon. At the festival you'll be able to tour Heritage Park's gardens, sample harvest bounty, enjoy hands-on activities, and listen to live music by local folk-rock band, The Stragglyrs.

One component of the event that may be of special interest to MVHA members will be the grand unveiling of the historic Immigrant House's period-appropriate furnishings. Some items that will be placed inside the Immigrant House came from the Pear family ranch in Mountain View and other items were actually in the house itself in the 1920s.

Of course, fresh fruit and vegetables were plentiful in Mountain View's rich agricultural past, but every once in a while people would go out and buy canned goods too. Among the treasures we picked up from the United Methodist Women's rummage sale was an antique can of green beans. So we're stocking Immigrant House's larder in anticipation of the big refurnishing reveal!

For more information about this FREE event, contact Mountain View Parks and Recreation at (650) 903-6331. Participants include: MVHA, UCC Master Food Preservers, Master Gardener Program, Soil & Water, Santa Clara Water Color Society, Santa Clara Bee Keepers, Friends of Immigrant House, MV Kiwanis Club and Key Club and Mountain View Parks and Rec. Dept.

An event flyer is also included on page four of this newsletter. Hope to see you there!

Kiwanis Club of Mountain View and City of Mountain View Presents :



Free Acoustic Music ,
Children's Activities , Art Projects & Garden Tour

FEATURING:

Immigrant House's NEW Decorated Interior Reveal
"Greenie" Mountain View's Vintage Farm Truck, Canning Demo, Honey Tasting
Soil and Water's Garden Demonstration w/ Harvest Sampling

MEET YOUR NEIGHBORS – Please Bike or Walk to event
FOR MORE INFORMATION CALL CITY OF MOUNTAIN VIEW RECREATION DIVISION AT 650-903-6331

Spring Meeting Photos
THE PEOPLING OF SILICON VALLEY



Local author Tim Stanley shares a fascinating slide show chronicling the origins and history of the local high-tech industry based on research completed for his new book, *The Peopling of Silicon Valley.*



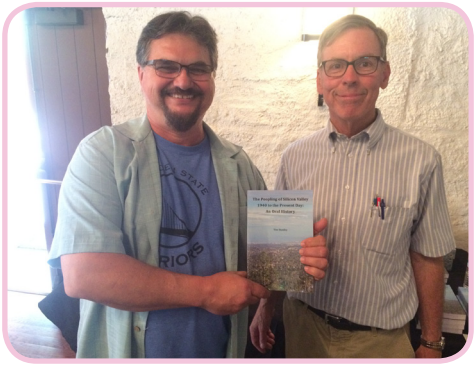
Members and guests listen to local author Tim Stanley's slide show talk in the Adobe Building.



New MVHA member Melissa Wright (left) and MVHA Treasurer Emily Ramos take a look at a draft of the new MVHA website Melissa is designing for our organization.



Longtime MVHA members Wallace Erichsen (left) and Arline Norsworthy.



MVHA member Mark Perry (left) and our special guest, local author Tim Stanley.

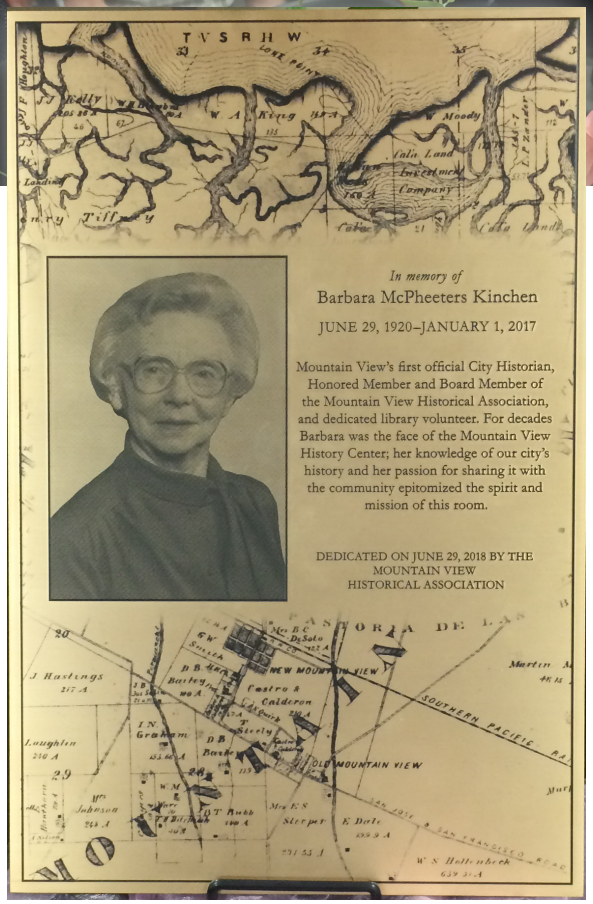


Regina Sakols, MVHA's newest Board Member.

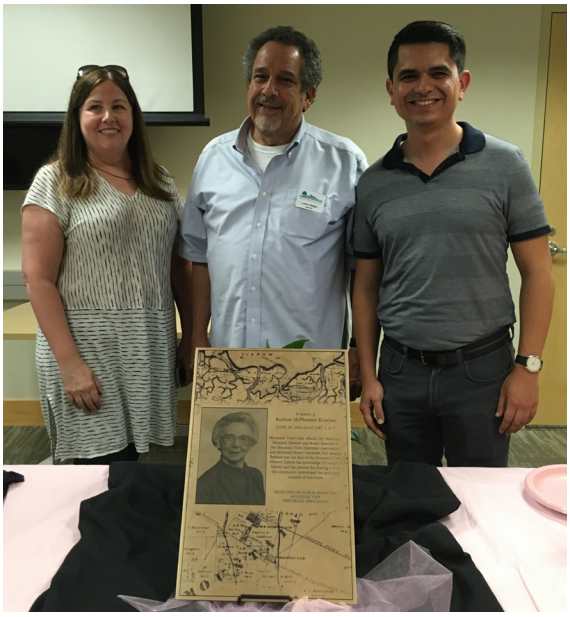
Barbara Kinchen Plaque Dedication



Wallace Erichsen shares memories of Barbara Kinchen with family and friends gathered for the plaque dedication.



The bronze plaque (designed by MVHA Vice President Nick Perry) features a portrait of Barbara and a circa 1876 map of Mtn. View.



From left to right: MVHA President Candace Bowers, Mountain View Mayor Lenny Siegel, and MVHA Vice President Nick Perry at the plaque dedication ceremony.

On June 29, 2017 the MVHA hosted a small gathering at the Mountain View Public Library to dedicate a plaque in honor of our first official City Historian, the late Barbara McPheeters Kinchen. The celebration took place on Barbara and her twin sister Betty's birthday. We were very honored to be joined by Betty and multiple generations of their family as well as many of Barbara's friends, past and present MVHA Board Members, and local leaders like Mayor Lenny Siegel and Council Member Margaret Abe-Koga. A special thanks to long-time MVHA member Wallace Erichsen for initiating and donating funds for this special tribute to Barbara. The plaque will be installed in the Mountain View History Center.



Betty Engberg (Barbara's twin sisters) takes a closer look at the newly unveiled plaque.

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
Membership Chair

Thank you everybody for your patience as we have been in flux the last few months. We would like to welcome, Melissa & Nick Wright, Daniel Welch, Shannon Badiee, and Regina Sakols to the MVHA family!

For our annual members, a friendly reminder that you can renew your membership using the form below or online via our website:

www.mountainviewhistorical.org

As always, If you have any questions on the status of your membership, please email mvha.membership@gmail.com, write us at the mailing address listed below on the membership form, or call me at (650) 215-0254.

Membership as of August 7, 2018

Honored Members	1
Life Members	112
Family Members	68
Single Members	65
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**246**

Thank you all for your membership and support!

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Below are some immediate needs:

History Center: Help us share our historic archives with the public at the library.

Board Positions: Board nominations are currently open for our November election. We warmly welcome anyone interested in taking on a leadership role with MVHA. Our Board meets only four times a year, so the time commitment is small, but the impact is huge! Interested? Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

E-mail: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
Mountain View Historical Association
c/o Lisa Garcia
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

SUMMER/FALL

August 19
Sunday, 1:00 to 3:00 p.m.
MVHA Summer Event/Meeting
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
See Page 1 for Details!

Sept. 11
Wednesday, 6:00 to 8:00 p.m.
MVHA Summer Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.
All interested members welcome to attend!

Sept. 22
Saturday, 9:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m.
Inaugural Harvest History Festival
Heritage Park–771 N. Rengstorff Ave.
For more information, see page 3.

November 4
Sunday, 1:00 to 3:00 p.m.
MVHA Fall Event/Meeting
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
More info in our fall newsletter.

Looking Back: Photos from the Archive



The historic image above shows an apricot-cutting party that took place in a Mountain View orchard in 1896. Like much of Santa Clara Valley's agricultural lands, the orchard where this picture was taken was developed decades ago. This particular site is now home to the San Antonio Shopping Center.



But did you know that one commercial orchard remains in Mountain View? It's the Francia orchard on Whisman Road (pictured to the left). And guess which crop is grown there? Apricots! Come celebrate this wonderful fruit at our summer membership meeting and event on August 19. Details on Page 1.

Historic image from the collection of Wallace Erichsen & Ruth Job Erichsen

EST. 1954

MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

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EMAIL: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

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